

Beyond the Book: Digital Research, Presentation, and Sustainability

A 1.5-day workshop on the production, presentation, and long-term sustainability of digital research in non-Latin script languages

Dates 21–22 September 2026 **Venue** Freie Universität Berlin · Otto-von-Simson-Straße 7 · 14195 Berlin

Format On site only

DAY 1 · MONDAY, 21 SEPTEMBER 2026 Section I — NLP and Digital Research Methods

13:00 – 13:30 Registration & Welcome Coffee
Arrival and informal networking

13:30 – 14:00 Opening Remarks
Introduction to the workshop aims, themes, and programme

14:00 – 15:00 **Keynote — Prof. Dr. Ingo Scholtes**
Machine Learning for Complex Networks, CAIDAS, Julius-Maximilians-Universität Würzburg · followed by questions & discussion

15:00 – 15:15 Coffee break

15:15 – 15:40 **Maida Farooq** · Martin Luther University Halle-Wittenberg
From Digitized Images to Sustainable Research Data — An Adaptive, Self-Improving Pipeline for Heterographic Ottoman-Era Print (Karamanlidika and Armeno-Turkish)

15:40 – 16:05 **Marcus Pöckelmann** · Freie Universität Berlin
Hittite state treaties as a case study to test the processing of cuneiform texts in LERA

16:05 – 16:35 **Panel Discussion — NLP**
Scholtes, Farooq, and Pöckelmann

DAY 2 · TUESDAY, 22 SEPTEMBER 2026 · MORNING Section II — Digital Scholarly Communication

09:30 – 10:00 Coffee & Networking
Informal exchange

10:00 – 11:00 **Keynote — Dr. Maxim G. Romanov**
Emmy Noether research group “The Evolution of Islamic Societies (c. 600–1600 CE)”, Universität Hamburg · introduced by Christian D. Casey · followed by questions & discussion

11:00 – 11:15 Coffee break

11:15 – 11:40 **Tal Bernstein** · Tel Aviv University (with Prof. Dr. Letizia Cerqueglini)
From Digital Edition to Interactive Argument: Publishing Philological Interpretation

11:40 – 12:05 **Oualid El-Khattabi** · Freie Universität Berlin
When You Can See All of It at Once: Synoptic Record, Synoptic Navigation, Derived Maps

12:05 – 12:35 **Panel Discussion — Digital Scholarly Communication**
Romanov, Bernstein, El-Khattabi, and Casey

12:35 – 14:00 Lunch
Networking

DAY 2 · TUESDAY, 22 SEPTEMBER 2026 · AFTERNOON Section III — Sustainability of Digital Scholarship

14:00 – 15:00 **Keynote — Prof. Dr. Frank Fischer**
Professor of Digital Humanities, Freie Universität Berlin · introduced by Joudy Sido Bozan · followed by questions & discussion

15:00 – 15:15 Coffee break

15:15 – 15:40 **Marwa Ahmed** · Freie Universität Berlin
Beyond the Book: Building a Sustainable AI-Driven Scholarly Edition for Arabic Manuscripts

15:40 – 16:05 **Lingyue Ma** · Freie Universität Berlin
A method for comparing computational procedures in premodern Chinese astronomical texts

16:05 – 16:35 **Panel Discussion — Sustainability of Digital Scholarship**
Fischer, Ahmed, Ma, and Sido Bozan

16:35 – 16:45 Closing Discussion & Reflections
Key outcomes, future collaborations, and concluding remarks

Speakers & Abstracts

Maida Farooq Martin Luther University Halle-Wittenberg

From Digitized Images to Sustainable Research Data

Presents an adaptive OCR pipeline for multilingual Ottoman-era materials (Karamanlidika and Armeno-Turkish) that automatically selects the best segmentation and OCR models using vision-language models. The pipeline continuously improves itself while generating reusable research data for historically under-resourced script-language pairs.

Marcus Pöckelmann Freie Universität Berlin

Hittite state treaties as a case study for LERA

Demonstrates the use of the LERA collation platform on Hittite cuneiform treaties, evaluating computational collation methods for highly fragmentary ancient texts and discussing the challenges of digitally processing early writing systems.

Tal Bernstein Tel Aviv University · with Prof. Dr. Letizia Cerqueglini

From Digital Edition to Interactive Argument

Introduces the “interactive philological argument,” where digital editions become explorable scholarly environments linking evidence, editorial decisions, provenance, and interpretation rather than merely presenting a final text.

Oualid El-Khattabi Freie Universität Berlin

Synoptic Record, Synoptic Navigation, Derived Maps

Proposes the concepts of the synoptic record and synoptic navigation, arguing that AI-assisted collation enables entirely new ways of exploring, visualizing, and navigating large textual traditions beyond the traditional critical edition.

Marwa Ahmed Freie Universität Berlin

A Sustainable AI-Driven Scholarly Edition for Arabic Manuscripts

Presents an AI-powered digital edition platform for Arabic manuscripts that integrates HTR, multilingual processing, interactive visualization, cloud infrastructure, APIs, and a sustainable software architecture designed for long-term preservation and reuse.

Lingyue Ma Freie Universität Berlin

Comparing computational procedures in premodern Chinese astronomical texts

Introduces MATHesis, a computational framework for comparing procedures in premodern Chinese astronomical texts through rule-based extraction, structured modeling, and transparent, reproducible analytical workflows that support future reuse and interpretation.

ORGANIZED BY

Joudy Sido Bozan and **Christian D. Casey**

Closing the Gap in Non-Latin Script Data

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CONTACT

closingthegap.github.io/contribute